

Where we are, and what to do this month

Everything in today's money. Numbers come from `plan/assumptions.json` (prepared 2026-09-20) and the observations listed at the foot; nothing on this page is typed by hand.

Retire **2035** Spend **£70k** a year to then, **£60k** after Equity **2% real** in the planning case

Gilts at the **21 Sep 2026** curve

£1.63M

Everything outside the house
and the business, 1 Sep 2026

£909k

Index-linked gilt ladder, rungs
2035–2045

£99k

Redeemed by each ISA rung
(£106k per SIPP rung), plus
coupons

£2.28M

Pots at retirement, 2035,
planning case

£2.21M

Left at 2075 after £60,000 a
year, planning case

55%

Abby's AVC for the rest of
2026/27; take-home about
£2,549 a month

Inputs check: **RED**

- **OK** pots.chrislilsa: assumed 276,716 vs snapshot 276,716 (2026-09-01, 0.0%)
- **OK** pots.abbyVanguardIlsa: assumed 312,573 vs snapshot 312,573 (2026-09-01, 0.0%)
- **OK** pots.chrisIISipp: assumed 439,574 vs snapshot 439,574 (2026-09-01, 0.0%)
- **OK** pots.chrisAccenturePension: assumed 193,081 vs snapshot 193,081 (2026-09-01, 0.0%)
- **OK** pots.abbyAccentureDc: assumed 282,921 vs snapshot 282,921 (2026-09-01, 0.0%)
- **OK** pots.otherSavings: assumed 119,924 vs snapshot 119,924 (2026-09-01, 0.0%)
- **OK** pots.accentureShares: assumed 1,960 vs snapshot 1,960 (2026-09-01, 0.0%)
- **RED** spend.planLine: trailing-12m spend 84,157 vs plan line 70,000 (+14,157)
- **OK** payslip age: newest payslip 2026-08-28 is 24 days old
- **OK** payslip.basicAnnual: assumption 73,837.8 vs payslip 73,837.8
- **OK** ladder rungs: 0 of 0 bought, cost 0 of budget 909,390

Abby's payslip: what to set

From the 2026-08 payslip (tax month 5): doing nothing, adjusted net income lands at £83,015. To finish the year at £59,500 the remaining 7 payslips need £23,515 of extra sacrifice, so **set the AVC to 55%** (£3,384 a payslip). Income then lands at £59,325, take-home falls by about £1,963 to £2,549 a month, and paid basic stays at £29,904 against a minimum-wage floor of £26,508 (fine).

The pivot: Abby's salary sacrifice, year by year

Modelled to the £60,000 line, operated to £59,500. Over the programme: £254k extra into her pension for £151k of take-home, keeping £23k of child benefit.

Tax year	AVC %	Extra sacrifice	Take-home given up	Child benefit kept
2026/27	30%	£22,037	£12,781	£2,337
2027/28	32%	£23,521	£13,642	£2,384
2028/29	33%	£25,035	£14,520	£2,432
2029/30	34%	£26,579	£15,947	£2,480
2030/31	36%	£28,154	£16,892	£2,530
2031/32	37%	£29,761	£17,856	£2,581
2032/33	38%	£31,399	£18,839	£2,632
2033/34	39%	£33,071	£19,842	£2,685
2034/35	41%	£34,775	£20,865	£2,739

How the plan holds up

Equity return, every year	At retirement	After the last rung	At the end	Lifetime tax	Cash runs out
0% real	£2.12M	£1.71M	£430k	£56k	never
2% real	£2.28M	£2.20M	£2.21M	£516	never
4% real	£2.47M	£2.87M	£6.68M	£516	never

Spend £60k a year from retirement, state pensions of £13k each from 2051 and 2054. The full ledger, the spend × return grid and the historical replay are in `ledger.html` .

Scenarios

Same engine, different knobs. "Cash out" is the first year the cash line goes negative; "reserve draw" is what the pre-retirement cash flow takes from the reserve by 2035.

Scenario	0% real			2% real			At retirement	At end
	At retirement	At end	Cash out	At retirement	At end	Cash out		
Planning case: 60k a year for life the accepted plan	£2.12M	£430k	—	£2.28M	£2.21M	—	£2.47M	£6
70k a year for life the pre-retirement plan line carried on for life	£2.11M	–£52k	2073	£2.27M	£1.49M	—	£2.46M	£5
80k a year for life the 2026 pace carried on for life	£2.10M	–£475k	2066	£2.26M	£717k	—	£2.45M	£4
80k to 2040, then 65k heavy years while the children are at home, then 65k	£2.10M	£79k	—	£2.26M	£1.67M	—	£2.45M	£5
Reserve spent before retirement	£2.00M	£280k	—	£2.15M	£1.99M	—	£2.32M	£6

Scenario	0% real			2% real			At retirement	At end
	At retirement	At end	Cash out	At retirement	At end	Cash out		
cash buffer and crypto both gone by 2035; otherwise the planning case								
Chris £20k take-home, spend 70k, to retirement household cash flow to 2035 with HB + side income at £20k take-home; shortfalls from the reserve	£2.09M	£377k	—	£2.25M	£2.17M	—	£2.43M	£6
Chris £20k take-home, spend 80k, to retirement as above at the 2026 spending pace	£2.01M	£286k	—	£2.17M	£2.02M	—	£2.35M	£6
Ratchet forward: Accenture	£2.17M	£548k	—	£2.29M	£2.25M	—	£2.43M	£6

Scenario	0% real			2% real			At retirement	A
	At retirement	At end	Cash out	At retirement	At end	Cash out		
pot → 2046–50 rungs transfer the L&G Accenture pension into the SIPP and buy five more rungs now (yields as observed); floor extends to 2050								

What this model knowingly gets wrong

- **tfc-nominal-cap** — Tax-free cash is modelled as a cumulative real allowance of £268,275 each, with no 25%-of-crystallised-pot limit. The lump sum allowance is frozen in cash ($\approx$ £195k real by 2041) and 25% of each pot is $\approx$ £200k, so the model over-counts tax-free money by about £145k real. Lifetime drawdown tax is about £44k at 2% real and £115k at 0%, not $\approx$ £0. (*tax narrative only; survival unaffected*) **fix by 2027-06-01**
- **thresholds-held-real** — Personal allowance, basic-rate band and state pension are held constant in real terms for the whole simulation. The allowance is frozen in cash to April 2031 ($\approx$ £11.5k real by then); the state pension is uprated by the triple lock. Small, opposite-signed biases. ($\approx$ £0.5k/yr of tax from 2041)
- **iht-not-modelled** — Pensions join the estate for inheritance tax from April 2027. The planning case leaves roughly £1.8M in pensions at 2075, implying IHT of the order of £850k plus beneficiary income tax. Drawing to the basic-rate band from 2041 should become the planning case; it is not yet. (*dominant tax in every path; not a spending risk*)
- **nic-cap-2029** — From April 2029 salary-sacrificed pension contributions above £2,000/yr attract employee and employer NIC. MODELLED from 21 Sep 2026 (tax.salarySacrificeNicCapFromTaxYear / Threshold): the pivot loses the NI part of the relief on the AVC from 2029/30 (about £3.7k over the programme) and take-home reflects it. NOT modelled: Accenture withdrawing or capping the salary-sacrifice AVC facility once its own 15% employer-NIC saving disappears — confirm the facility survives before relying on 2029/30+ years. ($\approx$ £3.7k take-home now in the numbers; *scheme-availability risk unquantified*) **fix by 2029-04-06**
- **fees-and-crypto** — Platform and dealing fees ($\sim$ £8k to 2045) are unmodelled; crypto ($\sim$ £54k) is treated as equity at 2% real and never drawn; the sustainable-spend column in the ledger document is the 3 Sep

outlook figure and £70k/yr does not survive the flat-0% case under the ledger's tax rules. (*small*)

Inputs behind this page

Assumptions	<code>plan/assumptions.json</code> prepared 2026-09-20 — register in <code>assumptions.md</code>
Gilt prices	2026-09-21T09:18:18.085Z (live)
Gilt yields for the ledger	2026-09-21
Payslip	2026-08 (tax month 5)
Snapshots	2026-09-01